

Analytical Marxism and Contemporary Policy Challenges Topics/Questions

* Indicates required question

1. How do contemporary analytical Marxists like John Roemer reframe Marx's original theory of exploitation for the 21st-century global economy? Discuss specific ways their approach differs from classical Marxist thought. *

2. Analyze how the concept of 'alienation' might apply to modern digital labor practices, such as gig economy work or content creation platforms like YouTube and TikTok. How do these platforms potentially reproduce or transform traditional Marxist understandings of worker alienation? *

3. Compare and contrast the approaches of Yiannis Varoufakis and G.A. Cohen in reimagining socialist economic theory. How do their perspectives differ in addressing contemporary economic inequalities? *

4. Evaluate the potential of market socialism as proposed by contemporary analytical Marxists. How might this economic model address the limitations of both traditional capitalism and state socialism? *

5. Discuss how the Marxist principle of 'to each according to their needs' might be reinterpreted in the context of universal basic income proposals. What are the potential benefits and challenges of such an approach? *

6. Analyze the concept of 'social equality' as discussed by David Miller. How does this differ from traditional distributive equality, and what implications might this have for contemporary social policy? *

7. Examine how intersectional approaches to social justice challenge or complement the traditional Marxist focus on class struggle. How might contemporary Marxist thinkers integrate insights from feminist and critical race theory? *

8. Critically assess the relevance of Marx's theory of alienation in the context of remote work and digital technologies. How do modern work arrangements both challenge and reinforce Marx's original insights? *

9. Explore the tensions between ambition-sensitivity and endowment-insensitivity in contemporary socialist thought. How do analytical Marxists like G.A. Cohen attempt to balance individual responsibility with structural inequalities? *

10. Discuss the evolution of Marxist thought from historical materialism to analytical Marxism. What key philosophical and methodological shifts have occurred in this transition? *

Citations

- [1] <https://www.marxists.org/>
- [2] <https://www.newleftreview.org/>
- [3] <https://www.versobooks.com/>
- [4] <https://www.jacobinmag.com/>
- [5] <https://www.socialeurope.eu/>

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